

The average company beat the index, and the biggest move was oil

The week finished higher, but not the way the last one did. **The equal weighted S and P rose 1.22 percent while the headline index rose 0.36 percent**, and **crude oil added 5.44 percent**, more than any index moved.

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01 The week

Where the week finished, at the Friday August 14 settle.

+0.36% S&P 500, week	+1.09% Nasdaq 100, week	+1.12% Russell 2000, week	14.26 VIX, from 14.90	4.70% US 10 year	+5.44% Crude oil, week
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Five sessions inside a 100 point range. The S and P futures opened the week at 7,776 and settled at 7,801, with the low on Tuesday and the high on Thursday.

MON 10 ES 7,776 Flat open to the week QUIET	TUE 11 ES 7,747 Week low 7,738, oil peaks 84.61 LOW	WED 12 ES 7,770 Recovers 23 points, NQ fails 30,000 TURN	THU 13 ES 7,822 Week high 7,838, NQ clears 30,000 HIGH	FRI 14 ES 7,801 Gives back 21, VIX 14.26 lowest of run CLOSE
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Green top means the session closed higher, red means lower, grey means flat.

02 The convoy caught up

Last week the biggest companies carried the number. This week they did not.

- **Cap weighted** (the S and P 500 you see quoted, where big companies count for more) rose **0.36 percent**. The **same 500 companies weighted equally** rose **1.22 percent**.
- **That gap runs backwards from last week**, when the headline index beat the equal weighted one by 1.4 points. **This week the equal weighted version won by 0.86 points**.

- Small companies agreed. The **Russell 2000 added 1.12 percent**, three times the headline index. **A rally that widens is healthier than one that narrows**, and this is the first week in three where breadth pointed that way.

03 Oil, and what it is not

For the second week running the largest move was not a stock. The asset changed.

- **WTI** (West Texas Intermediate, the main US crude oil benchmark) **rose 5.44 percent, from 78.18 to 82.43 dollars**, touching 84.61 on Tuesday. **No index came close to that.**
- Last week the outlier was gold at plus 7.79 percent. **Gold still added 1.99 percent this week**, so it did not hand anything over. It was simply passed.
- **Rising oil is a cost for almost every company that does not sell it**, which inverts last week, when cheaper energy sat as a tailwind under the rally. **The market rose anyway.**

04 Calm got calmer

Three supporting facts, all quiet.

- **VIX** (the market expectation of swing over the next month, priced from options) **fell from 14.90 to 14.26**, the lowest close of the whole run. **Nobody is paying up for protection.**
- The US 10 year finished at **4.70 percent**, four hundredths higher and effectively flat. **Borrowing costs did not argue with the rally.**
- The **Nasdaq 100 crossed 30,000 and held it**, closing above on Thursday and Friday after failing there three times on Wednesday.

05 What it means

The plain reading, without a forecast attached.

- **A small up week with widening participation and the lowest volatility of the run is a market that is not straining.**
- **The honest caution is oil.** Energy is an input cost for everyone else, and a 5 percent week in it takes a while to reach anyone's reported numbers.

THE ONE LINE

The index barely moved and the average company did better than it. When the equal weighted version wins, the rally got broader rather than thinner.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Index, futures, volatility, rates and commodity levels: Yahoo Finance daily bars, August 10 to 14 2026, pulled at the August 14 settle; Cap weighted against equal weighted: the S and P 500 index compared with RSP, the equal weight fund; Full weekly audit: 3-Trading/08-weekly/2026-08-16-recap.md.

Educational, not financial advice. A record of what the market did in one week, written to be read by someone who does not trade.

Glossary

Cap weighted An index where bigger companies count for more. The S and P 500 you see quoted is this one.

Equal weighted The same companies counted the same. Comparing the two tells you whether a rally is broad.

Breadth How many companies take part in a move. Wide breadth is a healthier rally than a narrow one.

VIX The market expectation of swing over the next 30 days, priced from options. Low means calm is being assumed.

WTI West Texas Intermediate, the main US crude oil benchmark.

Futures A contract to buy or sell later at a price agreed now. The S and P version trades nearly around the clock.
